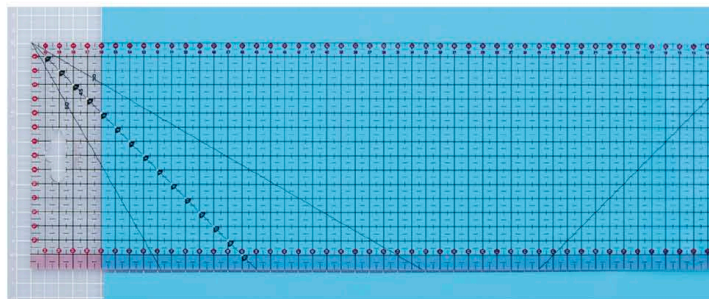


BINDINGS

Pre-made bias binding is available in various colours and widths, or you can make your own. Bindings should be applied as a continuous strip. If possible, cut straight binding strips along the lengthways grain of the fabric

or join pieces before applying. Bias binding has more stretch than straight binding, making it suitable for binding work with curved edges.

MAKING A STRAIGHT BINDING STRIP



1 Measure the edges of the piece being bound and decide on the width of the finished binding. Cut strips six times this width plus an additional 1.2cm ($\frac{1}{2}$ in), allowing extra length for mitring corners and joining pieces.

2 Ensure your edges are square and cut along the straight grain of the fabric. Add about 40cm (16in) extra to the length for full quilts, 30cm (12in) for baby quilts, wall hangings, and large embroideries, and 20cm (8in) for small works.

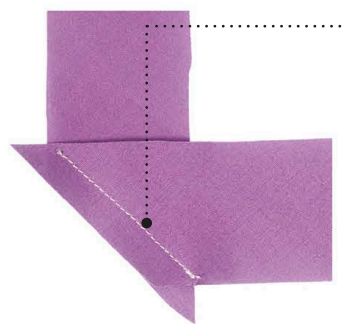
MAKING A BIAS STRIP



1 Buy at least 1.5m (59in) of fabric so you can cut very long strips. Cut off selvages and smooth the fabric flat. Straighten the right-hand edge of the fabric, then fold this edge back so that it aligns with the top edge and forms an exact 45-degree angle. Cut along this bias fold.



2 Using a metal ruler and a sharp piece of tailor's chalk, mark lines on the fabric parallel to the bias edge and 4cm ($1\frac{1}{2}$ in) apart. Cut out the strips along the chalked lines. Cut as many strips as you need for your project plus a few extra.



3 Join strips together to make a continuous strip. Pin the strips together at a 90-degree angle with right sides facing and sew a 6mm ($\frac{1}{4}$ in) seam on the bias. The seam should run from edge to edge of each strip, with a triangle of fabric left at either end of the seam.



4 Press the seam open and trim off the seam allowances and the extending little triangles (dog ears). You can also make bias binding with these prepared strips. To do this, press under the edges or run the strip through a bias binding maker.